

PROSPER AWUNI

Principal Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel | Microsoft Defender for Endpoint | Incident Response | Security Governance

United Kingdom (Hybrid/Remote) | +44 7403 190750 | prosper.awuni@gmail.com | linkedin.com/in/awuniprosper

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)-certified security engineer with over five years of progressive experience in the administration, operational management, and continuous improvement of enterprise cyber security platforms. I have deep hands-on expertise with Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM), Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Cloud, and the broader Microsoft 365 Defender suite, alongside CrowdStrike Falcon Endpoint Detection and Response (EDR) and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM). I am skilled in triaging and investigating security alerts, conducting root cause analysis, leading incident response activities in line with the National Institute of Standards and Technology (NIST) SP 800-61 framework, and translating complex technical findings into clear communications for both technical and non-technical stakeholders. In my current role at the University of the Arts, London (UAL) I am responsible for identifying gaps in existing cybersecurity policies and procedures, implementing compensating controls, and providing expert guidance on cyber security strategy, risk, and governance. I am seeking a senior principal-level position where I can apply expert platform knowledge and a threat-informed security mindset to strengthen organisational cyber resilience.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM and Security Operations:** Microsoft Sentinel (Kusto Query Language (KQL) analytics rules, workbooks, SOAR playbooks), CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, Splunk (Security Performance Language (SPL))
- **Endpoint and Identity Protection:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent/Insight/Discover
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Defender for Cloud, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, Conditional Access, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO)
- **Privileged Access Management (PAM):** BeyondTrust PAM, least-privilege access enforcement, privileged session recording
- **Incident Response and Threat Hunting:** NIST SP 800-61 incident response lifecycle; MITRE ATT&CK-informed threat hunting; alert triage, root cause analysis, and containment
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Security Governance and Policy:** Gap analysis; cybersecurity policy and procedure development; ISO 27001, CIS Controls, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), Cyber Essentials Plus
- **Stakeholder Communication:** Security incident reporting for C-suite and board audiences; risk-based briefings for non-technical leadership
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell scripting; SOAR automation and playbook development; detection logic tuning
- **Email and Endpoint Security:** Mimecast, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM) and Mobile Application Management (MAM), Tanium, Check Point Harmony

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer *March 2025 – Present*

- Provide expert advice on cyber security strategy, selecting, designing, and justifying security controls to protect an 8,000-user estate against evolving threats; contribute to the development and refinement of security policies and procedures.
- Administer and operationally manage Microsoft Sentinel SIEM, building and tuning KQL analytics rules and SOAR playbooks to automate alert triage, accelerate incident response, and reduce manual analyst workload.

- Monitor security tools including Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft Defender for Cloud, and CrowdStrike Falcon, triaging alerts and escalating incidents to appropriate response tiers.
- Lead incident response activities across the full NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle: detection, containment, eradication, and recovery; conduct thorough root cause analysis and produce post-incident reports for technical and non-technical stakeholders.
- Identify gaps in existing cybersecurity policies and technical controls, producing risk-prioritised remediation roadmaps and presenting findings to IT leadership and senior management.
- Administer Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Entra ID, enforcing Conditional Access policies, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and MFA across all user accounts to reduce identity-based attack surface.
- Manage BeyondTrust PAM, overseeing privileged account governance and enforcing least-privilege access across critical IT and operational systems.
- Lead vulnerability management cycles using Pentra BAS, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, prioritising findings by risk and tracking remediation to closure.
- Communicate cyber security risks, incidents, and programme updates effectively to both technical engineers and non-technical board and senior leadership audiences.
- Leverage Tanium for real-time endpoint compliance monitoring and vulnerability management, using asset discovery, software inventory and patch compliance modules to maintain accurate endpoint visibility and enforce compliance baselines across the estate.

University of the Arts, London (UAL) — Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity *March 2022 – March 2025*

- Deployed and maintained Microsoft Sentinel SIEM across the UAL estate, designing KQL detection rules and workbooks aligned to MITRE ATT&CK tactics and techniques, reducing mean time to detect (MTTD).
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) across 8,000 users, building automated response playbooks and reducing the attack surface for endpoint and identity-based threats.
- Administered Microsoft Defender for Cloud, monitoring cloud workload posture and remediating configuration findings across Azure environments.
- Conducted proactive threat hunting aligned to MITRE ATT&CK TTPs, identifying dormant threats including lateral movement, credential harvesting, and persistence mechanisms.
- Performed root cause analysis on security incidents, documenting findings and implementing preventive controls to reduce recurrence.
- Managed Microsoft Intune MDM/MAM policies to enforce device compliance and application protection across corporate and BYOD endpoints.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance activities, identifying control gaps and driving remediation.
- Administered Tanium endpoint management and CrowdStrike Falcon, ensuring continuous agent coverage and policy compliance across the estate.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS/FinTech) — IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure *February 2021 – March 2022*

- Managed endpoint security controls, firewall policies, and access governance across a cloud-hosted SaaS environment, monitoring security alerts and leading incident response for identified threats.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments, translating technical findings into risk-prioritised remediation plans and tracking progress with engineering and infrastructure teams.
- Enforced identity and access management controls including MFA and least-privilege access across cloud and on-premises platforms.
- Supported ISO 27001 compliance and security policy development; delivered security awareness training to staff across a distributed workforce.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Built and operationalised Microsoft Sentinel SIEM with custom KQL detection rules and SOAR automation playbooks, reducing analyst manual triage workload by over 40% at UAL.

- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Defender for Identity (MDI) across an 8,000-user estate, achieving full endpoint telemetry coverage and enabling identity-based threat detection within six months.
- Led incident response and root cause analysis for multiple high-severity security incidents, producing board-ready post-incident reports and implementing preventive controls to reduce recurrence.
- Identified and remediated critical gaps in UAL's cybersecurity policies and procedures, aligning the security posture to ISO 27001, NIST CSF, and Cyber Essentials Plus standards.
- Implemented BeyondTrust PAM governance framework, eliminating standing privileged access across critical systems and reducing the risk of privilege escalation attacks.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Salary Expectation: GBP 80,000-95,000 | Hybrid (London/UK)